

Andrea Zhang

MSc Candidate in Computer Science and Engineering

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Computer Science and Engineering MSc candidate with project experience in distributed systems, machine learning, and reward learning from human feedback. Seeking international software engineering or AI engineering opportunities.

EDUCATION

Politecnico di Milano - MSc, Computer Science and Engineering 2024 - expected Oct 2026

Weighted average: 29/30 as of 17 September 2026. Relevant coursework: Distributed Systems, Machine Learning, Recommender Systems, Artificial Neural Networks and Deep Learning.

Politecnico di Milano - BSc, Engineering of Computing Systems 2021 - 2024

Final grade: 107/110.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Reward learning from human feedback - Master's thesis

Built a Python framework that combines demonstrations and preferences to train a reward model for simulated driving in SUMO; compared hybrid learning with single-feedback baselines and reliability-weighted gradient fusion.

Replicated chat infrastructure

Built a Java chat system with replicated brokers, leader election, globally ordered delivery, failure detection, and client recovery over UDP and TCP.

Streaming regression in CapyMOA

Implemented a Hoeffding Adaptive Tree regressor for MOA and a Python CapyMOA wrapper; benchmarked prediction quality, execution time, and memory against River.

ACM RecSys Challenge 2026 - Hallucinated team

Member of a nine-student team that placed first on the final Blind-B leaderboard for conversational music recommendation. The team solution combined candidate retrieval, XGBoost reranking, and LLM response generation.

EXPERIENCE

Junior Consultant - Reply, Milan 2025

Worked with Microsoft Copilot Studio on multi-agent orchestration flows.

SKILLS & RECOGNITION

Technical: Python, Java, Git, distributed systems, machine learning, reinforcement learning, recommender systems, PyTorch, Stable-Baselines3, Maven.

Languages: Italian and Mandarin Chinese (C2); English (B2).

Recognition: Best Freshmen Award, academic year 2021-22, engineering class L-8 (Fondo Giovani).